

Name: _____

Period: _____

Date: _____

Topic 0.6 Guided Notes: The Psychological Perspectives

Unit 0: Science Practices | AP Psychology

Directions: Read through the topic overview page below and fill in each blank as you go. Use the tables and activities to check your understanding, then head to the quiz link at the end to test yourself.

Source page: appsychreviewhub.com/overviews/topic0.6

Word Bank

<i>Sociocultural Perspective</i>	<i>Biological Perspective</i>	<i>Psychodynamic Perspective</i>	<i>Behavioral Perspective</i>
<i>Humanistic Perspective</i>	<i>Evolutionary Perspective</i>	<i>Biopsychosocial Perspective</i>	<i>Cognitive Perspective</i>

1. The Seven Main Perspectives

Fill in the perspective being described. Each one explains the same behavior — severe test anxiety — through a different lens.

- _____ : links genetic, neural, and hormonal processes to behavior. Would explain test anxiety through an overactive amygdala, inherited predisposition, or a GABA imbalance.
- _____ : focuses entirely on observable behaviors learned through conditioning and reinforcement, ignoring internal thoughts. Would explain test anxiety as a conditioned response to a past harsh punishment after failing a test.
- _____ : focuses on how people think, perceive, remember, and solve problems. Would explain test anxiety as the result of irrational, catastrophic thinking.
- _____ : uses the principles of natural selection to explain behavior. Would explain test anxiety as an adaptive trait — cautious ancestors were more likely to survive.
- _____ : emphasizes the growth potential of healthy people and the drive toward self-actualization. Would explain test anxiety as a blocked sense of personal growth and self-worth.
- _____ : studies how unconscious drives and childhood conflicts influence behavior. Would explain test anxiety as a repressed, unconscious fear of disappointing a parent.
- _____ : studies how situations and cultures affect behavior and thinking. Would explain test anxiety through intense academic pressure from a student's cultural community.

Apply It: Which Lens Is This?

Each row below describes the SAME student's test anxiety through a different lens. Identify the perspective being used.

#	Explanation	Perspective
1	"Her brain's fear center is overreacting, and anxiety runs in her family."	
2	"She was harshly criticized after a past bad grade, so now she associates tests with fear."	

#	Explanation	Perspective
3	"She's telling herself failing this test means her whole future is ruined."	
4	"A little anxiety kept our ancestors alert to real threats — some of that wiring is still with us."	
5	"Her environment isn't letting her feel safe enough to reach her full potential."	
6	"She's unconsciously afraid of letting her parents down, rooted in her childhood."	
7	"Her community treats test scores as the only measure of a person's worth."	

2. Putting it All Together: The Biopsychosocial Approach

Are any of the seven perspectives "wrong"? No — but using only one lens gives an incomplete picture. Most modern psychologists rely on the _____ — an integrated approach that incorporates biological, psychological, and social-cultural levels of analysis.

Example: treating depression doesn't just mean prescribing medication (Biological) — it also means helping the patient reframe negative thoughts (Psychological/Cognitive) and improving their support network (Sociocultural). Treating the whole person yields the best results.

3. AP Science Practice Focus: Concept Application

Practice 1.A asks you to apply psychological perspectives, theories, concepts, and research findings to a scenario — you must be able to compare and contrast how different perspectives would explain the exact same behavior.

4. Quick Check: Review Questions

Circle the best answer for each question below.

1. A psychologist explains a patient's panic attacks by pointing to an overactive amygdala and an inherited imbalance of neurotransmitters like GABA. Which perspective is this psychologist using?

- A. Cognitive
- B. Humanistic
- C. Behavioral
- D. Biological

2. A therapist believes her client's fear of abandonment stems from unresolved, unconscious conflicts related to a parent's frequent absences during early childhood. This explanation is rooted in the:

- A. Biological Perspective
- B. Cognitive Perspective
- C. Psychodynamic Perspective
- D. Behavioral Perspective

3. A psychologist argues that humans evolved a strong fear of snakes and spiders because ancestors who avoided these dangers were more likely to survive and pass on their genes. This explanation reflects the:

- A. Humanistic Perspective
- B. Evolutionary Perspective
- C. Sociocultural Perspective
- D. Psychodynamic Perspective

4. A counselor believes her client feels unfulfilled because their restrictive work environment is blocking their natural drive toward personal growth and self-actualization. This explanation reflects the:

- A. Evolutionary Perspective
- B. Behavioral Perspective
- C. Humanistic Perspective
- D. Biological Perspective

5. A researcher explains that students from a culture that heavily emphasizes academic achievement experience more test-related stress because of the intense societal pressure and community expectations placed on them. This explanation reflects the:

- A. Sociocultural Perspective
- B. Biological Perspective
- C. Psychodynamic Perspective
- D. Cognitive Perspective

6. A student believes that failing one quiz means she is "a complete failure who will never succeed at anything." A psychologist explains her resulting anxiety is caused by this irrational, catastrophic thought pattern rather than by the quiz itself. This explanation reflects the:

- A. Cognitive Perspective
- B. Sociocultural Perspective
- C. Behavioral Perspective
- D. Evolutionary Perspective



Check Your Progress

Done with your notes? Head over to the [Unit 0 Quiz](https://appspsychreviewhub.com/quiz) to test what you've learned:

<https://appspsychreviewhub.com/quiz>